PLURALS WITH Y

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Write the plural of each word, then circle which rule you used. Look at the letter in front of the y: a consonant means change the y to i and add -es, a vowel means just add -s. Eight of these twelve take -ies and four take a plain -s.

Why -ies and not -ys. English does not like a y before an s at the end of a word, so cherry + s becomes cherries. But when a vowel comes first, the y is part of the vowel sound (to**y**, da**y**, ke**y**, monke**y**) and breaking it up would change how the word sounds, so nothing is changed and you simply add -s.

1.	cherry	plural →	_____	consonant + y	vowel + y
2.	toy	plural →	_____	consonant + y	vowel + y
3.	party	plural →	_____	consonant + y	vowel + y
4.	day	plural →	_____	consonant + y	vowel + y
5.	family	plural →	_____	consonant + y	vowel + y
6.	bunny	plural →	_____	consonant + y	vowel + y
7.	key	plural →	_____	consonant + y	vowel + y
8.	berry	plural →	_____	consonant + y	vowel + y
9.	monkey	plural →	_____	consonant + y	vowel + y
10.	country	plural →	_____	consonant + y	vowel + y
11.	daisy	plural →	_____	consonant + y	vowel + y
12.	turkey	plural →	_____	consonant + y	vowel + y

The three to watch: monkey, turkey and key all look like they should take -ies, and children write "monkies" constantly. Say the word slowly: mon-k-**ey**. The e is the vowel in front of the y, so it is just monkeys.

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PLURALS WITH Y ANSWER KEY

Name: ..... Date: .....

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Why -ies and not -ys. English does not like a y before an s at the end of a word, so cherry + s becomes cherries. But when a vowel comes first, the y is part of the vowel sound (toy, day, key, monkey) and breaking it up would change how the word sounds, so nothing is changed and you simply add -s.

1.	cherry	plural →	cherries	**consonant + y**	vowel + y
2.	toy	plural →	toys	consonant + y	**vowel + y**
3.	party	plural →	parties	**consonant + y**	vowel + y
4.	day	plural →	days	consonant + y	**vowel + y**
5.	family	plural →	families	**consonant + y**	vowel + y
6.	bunny	plural →	bunnies	**consonant + y**	vowel + y
7.	key	plural →	keys	consonant + y	**vowel + y**
8.	berry	plural →	berries	**consonant + y**	vowel + y
9.	monkey	plural →	monkeys	consonant + y	**vowel + y**
10.	country	plural →	countries	**consonant + y**	vowel + y
11.	daisy	plural →	daisies	**consonant + y**	vowel + y
12.	turkey	plural →	turkeys	consonant + y	**vowel + y**

The three to watch: monkey, turkey and key all look like they should take -ies, and children write "monkies" constantly. Say the word slowly: mon-k-**ey**. The e is the vowel in front of the y, so it is just monkeys.

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